

Incident Report

Alert Description:

Email Gateway – Detection of **Suspicious Embedded Macros** in an attachment from an external domain.

Detection Source:

Email Gateway

Detection Time:

2025-03-05 09:46:22-08:00

Sender:

Accounts.Avi Enterprises – accounts@avienterprise.com

Recipient:

info@cybersecxperts.com

Incident Summary

On 2025-03-05 09:46:22-08:00, the Email Gateway detected **suspicious embedded macros** in an attachment sent from accounts@avienterprise.com to info@cybersecxperts.com.

- The attachment **ACCOUNTS STATEMENT.x1s** contained macros flagged as **Exploit, Trojan & Malware** by multiple AV vendors.
- **Hash Analysis:** Confirmed malicious via threat intelligence feeds.
- **Internal Impact Check:** No signs of compromise or infection within internal systems.
- Preventive controls (Email Gateway + EDR) were already configured to block such threats.

Source IP Analysis

- **IP Address:** 52.101.194.10

- **Reputation Check:** Not found in AbuseIPDB (no prior reports of malicious activity).
- **ISP:** Microsoft Corporation
- **Location:** Chicago, Illinois, USA

Log Analysis

Email Gateway Findings:

- **Subject:** “Due Payments Release” – Social engineering technique using urgency.
- **Attachment:** ACCOUNTS STATEMENT.xls – Enabled macros prompt on open.

Splunk Query Used:

```
index=main sourcetype="email_logs" "accounts@avienterprise.com"
| table SenderIP Sender Recipient Email_Subject Status Action
Attachment_Name Attachment_Hash
```

Hash Verification:

- The hash of ACCOUNTS STATEMENT.xls was submitted to threat intelligence sources.
- Multiple vendors confirmed the file as **Exploit, Trojan, and Malware**.

IOC Scoping

We performed scoping across the enterprise to check if the malicious attachment hash was observed elsewhere.

Splunk Query Used:

```
index=main "0c022982324f9c68037f2a3677492695"
| table _time Action Sender SenderIP Recipient Email_Subject URL
Reason Attachment_Name
```

Result: No further instances of the malicious attachment were detected.

Actions Taken

- Blocked the malicious domain and sender via Email Gateway.
- Enabled **hash-based blocking** in both EDR and Email Gateway.
- Monitored internal hosts for execution attempts (none observed).
- User awareness alert raised internally regarding **malicious macro-based attachments**.

Conclusion

- **Classification:** True Positive
- **Impact:** None – email blocked, no user executed the file.
- **Current Status:** Domain blocked at Email Gateway; malicious hash blocked in EDR.
- **Ticket Status:** Closed.